Leave Policy

Leave entitlements, requests, approval, records, and fair administration

Policy owner	Human Resources
Status	Proposed revised draft pending management, HR, and legal approval
Proposed version	3.0
Review cycle	Annual or when law or operations change
Supersedes after approval	Leave_Policy_v2.0.docx

Approval notice. This proposed revision preserves the intent of the approved source policy and adds controls commonly expected in a mature policy framework. It does not replace version 2.0 until formally approved. Applicable law and written employment terms prevail where they provide a higher standard or different mandatory requirement.

Objective

This policy helps employees balance professional and personal responsibilities while allowing the company to plan work fairly. It states the existing leave entitlements and establishes a consistent process for notice, approval, records, emergencies, privacy, and review.

Scope and Leave Year

The policy applies to all employees, subject to eligibility in applicable law, employment terms, and approved entity-specific rules. The leave year is the calendar year unless Human Resources publishes a different approved schedule for the relevant entity. Where law or contract provides a more favorable entitlement, that entitlement prevails.

Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibilities
Employee	Check balance, give required notice where possible, submit accurate dates and supporting documents, obtain written approval, and update the manager if circumstances change.
Manager	Consider requests promptly and consistently, balance employee needs with coverage, avoid retaliation, document decisions, and escalate exceptions to Human Resources.
Human Resources	Maintain leave rules and records, advise on eligibility and protected leave,

Role	Responsibilities
	protect medical information, audit consistency, and publish the leave calendar and process.
Payroll	Apply approved paid or unpaid leave records accurately and correct confirmed errors.

Leave Entitlements

Sick Leave

- Employees are entitled to 20 days of sick leave per year.
- A doctor's certificate is required for continuous sick leave exceeding 2 days, subject to reasonable exceptions and applicable law.
- Employees should notify the manager as soon as reasonably possible on the first day of absence and provide expected duration without being required to disclose unnecessary medical details.
- Medical records will be restricted to authorized Human Resources personnel and used only for legitimate leave, safety, accommodation, benefits, or legal purposes.

Paid Leave

- Employees accrue 1.5 days of paid leave per month, credited to the leave balance each month.
- Up to 10 days may be carried forward into the next leave year.
- Paid leave is not encashable except where applicable law or an approved separation rule requires payment.
- Requests for up to 5 days and planned requests exceeding 5 days may be considered. This wording does not create an additional leave category or extra balance; all requests remain subject to available balance, notice, approval, coverage, and applicable law.

Unpaid Leave

Unpaid leave results in loss of pay for the approved unpaid period. It may apply when no paid balance is available or when an eligible unpaid absence is approved. An unapproved absence or failure to report to work may affect pay, but the company will review the facts and reasonable contact attempts before making a disciplinary conclusion.

Paternity Leave

Eligible employees receive 5 days of paternity leave. The employee should provide reasonable notice and the limited supporting information needed to administer the leave. A higher mandatory entitlement prevails.

Maternity Leave

Eligible employees receive 90 days of maternity leave with full salary for the entire three-month period. Any greater entitlement, job protection, health protection, nursing break, or related benefit required by applicable law prevails. Human Resources will explain the process and documentation confidentially.

Complimentary Leave

- Employees who work on a public holiday or weekly day off will receive complimentary leave when the work was authorized and recorded.
- Complimentary leave must be requested within 2 months of the qualifying work or it expires, unless law or an approved written exception requires otherwise.
- Only 1 complimentary leave day may be used at a time, followed by a cooldown of 1 working week before the next complimentary leave day.

Other Statutory or Special Leave

Bereavement, adoption, caregiving, disability-related, civic, military, election, miscarriage, or other statutory or special leave will be provided where applicable law, contract, or another approved policy requires it. Human Resources will confirm eligibility and terms; this policy does not invent an entitlement where none has been approved.

Request and Approval Process

1. Check the available balance in Spark or the approved HRMS where available. A displayed balance is a record for review and may require Human Resources correction if inaccurate.
2. Submit the request through Spark or the approved leave request form to the supervisor. Planned vacation leave requires at least 30 days' notice. Other short-term planned leave requires at least 1 week of notice.
3. For illness or emergency, notify the manager as soon as reasonably possible and submit the request or supporting record when able.
4. The manager reviews balance, notice, operational coverage, overlapping requests, fairness, and any protected or statutory requirement, and records approval or denial in writing.
5. Leave is not confirmed until approved, except where emergency or applicable law means prior approval is not reasonably possible. The employee should not make non-refundable commitments before approval.
6. Changes, extensions, early returns, or cancellations must be updated promptly in the same system or form.

Decision Standards and Exceptions

Managers should respond promptly, apply criteria consistently, and explain a denial or proposed alternative. They must not deny protected leave or retaliate against an employee for using or requesting eligible leave. Exceptions may be approved case by case by the reporting manager with Human Resources review where the exception affects entitlement, pay, precedent, or legal compliance.

Reconsideration and Corrections

An employee may ask Human Resources to review a denial, balance, payroll impact, or inconsistent application. The employee should provide the request date, leave type, dates, decision, and the specific concern. Human Resources will review the record and communicate the result. Payroll corrections will follow the payroll correction process.

Records, Privacy, and Review

Leave, approval, medical, and payroll records will be accurate, access-controlled, and retained according to the company schedule and applicable law. Managers will receive only the information necessary to plan work and administer the absence. Human Resources will review entitlements and this policy at least annually.

Reference Framework

These sources informed the proposed controls as non-binding benchmarks. They do not replace applicable law, employment contracts, or approved company policy.

- Digital Personal Data Protection Act 2023: https://www.meity.gov.in/static/uploads/2024/02/Digital-Personal-Data-Protection-Act-2023.pdf

Document History

Version	Status	Summary	Reviewer
1.0	Internal review	Original internal policy review	Management
2.0	Approved	Approved source policy version 2.0	Imran Khan
3.0	Draft	Revised policy draft	Pending